

INDIA, CHINA, MAJOR POWERS AND RESILIENT SUPPLY CHAINS

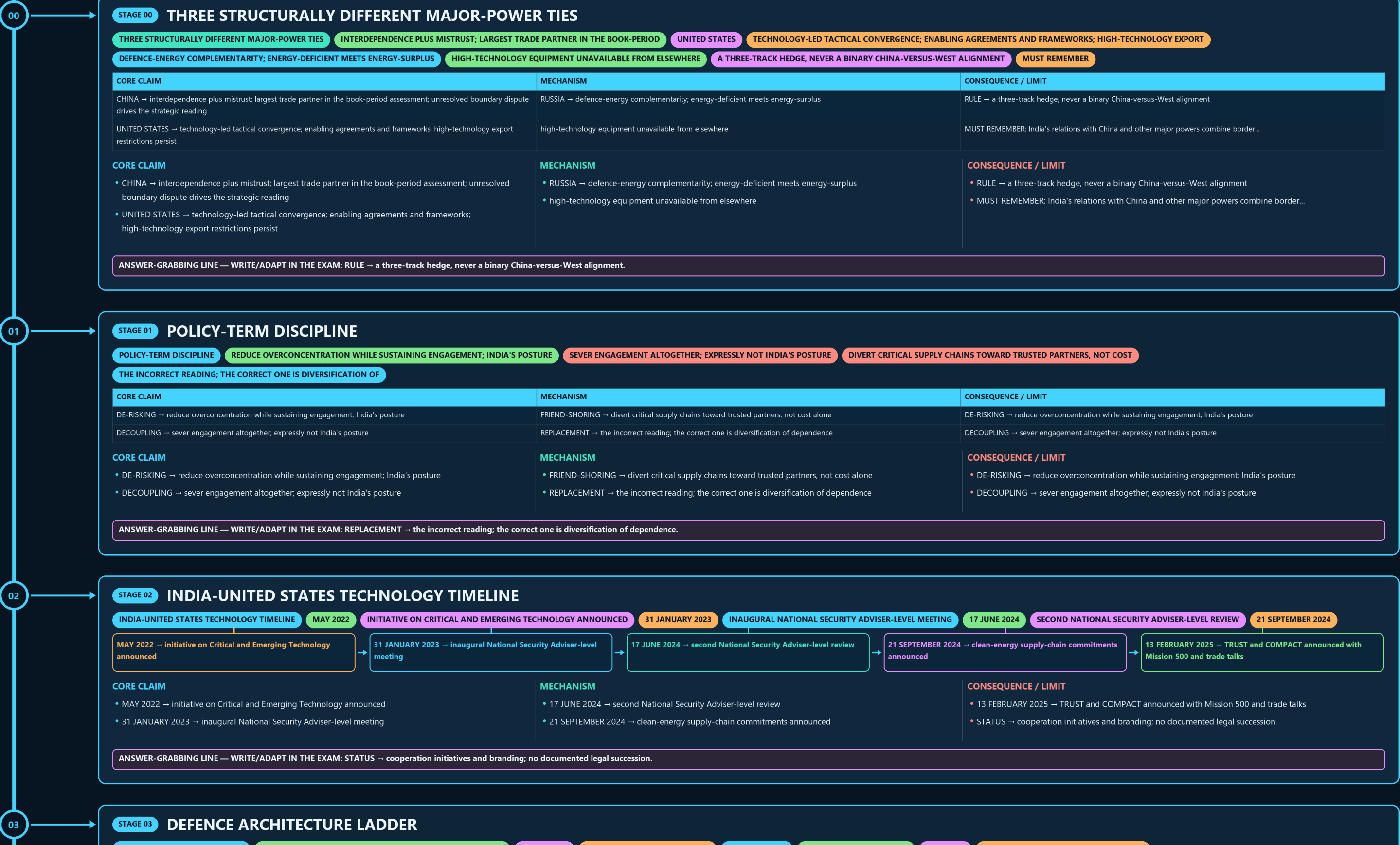
THREE STRUCTURALLY DIFFERENT MAJOR-POWER → POLICY-TERM DISCIPLINE → INDIA-UNITED STATES TECHNOLOGY TIMELINE → DEFENCE ARCHITECTURE LADDER → RUSSIA TRACK EVIDENCE CARD → INDIA-CHINA PROCESS ARCHITECTURE

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

PRIMARY CORE FLOW SUBORDINATE EXTRA APPROVAL / REVIEW

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • source generation g5 and all prior artifacts unchanged

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles



03

CORE CLAIM

- MAY 2022 → initiative on Critical and Emerging Technology announced
- 31 JANUARY 2023 → inaugural National Security Adviser-level meeting

MECHANISM

- 17 JUNE 2024 → second National Security Adviser-level review
- 21 SEPTEMBER 2024 → clean-energy supply-chain commitments announced

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- 13 FEBRUARY 2025 → TRUST and COMPACT announced with Mission 500 and trade talks
- STATUS → cooperation initiatives and branding; no documented legal succession

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: STATUS → cooperation initiatives and branding; no documented legal succession.

03

STAGE 03

DEFENCE ARCHITECTURE LADDER

DEFENCE ARCHITECTURE LADDER

INDIA DESIGNATED A MAJOR DEFENCE PARTNER BY THE UNITED STATES

LEMOA 2016

RECIPROCAL LOGISTICS SUPPORT

COMCASA 2018

SECURE COMMUNICATIONS

BECA 2020

EXCHANGE OF GEOSPATIAL INFORMATION

2016 → India designated a Major Defence Partner by the United States

LEMOA 2016 → reciprocal logistics support

COMCASA 2018 → secure communications

BECA 2020 → exchange of geospatial information

CORE CLAIM

- 2016 → India designated a Major Defence Partner by the United States
- LEMOA 2016 → reciprocal logistics support

MECHANISM

- COMCASA 2018 → secure communications
- BECA 2020 → exchange of geospatial information

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- 31 OCTOBER 2025 → ten-year Framework for the US-India Major Defense Partnership
- LIMIT → enabling agreements and a framework; no collective defence, no basing right

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: LIMIT → enabling agreements and a framework; no collective defence, no basing right.

04

STAGE 04

RUSSIA TRACK EVIDENCE CARD

RUSSIA TRACK EVIDENCE CARD

INDIA ENERGY-DEFICIENT, RUSSIA ENERGY-SURPLUS

UNIQUE SUPPLY

HIGH-TECHNOLOGY EQUIPMENT INCLUDING NUCLEAR-POWERED SUBMARINES

INSTALLED BASE

SU-30MKI LICENSED PRODUCTION; BRAHMOS JOINT VENTURE

S-400 CONTRACT AS THE NAMED HIGH-END ACQUISITION

INDO-RUSSIAN RIFLES PRIVATE LIMITED AT KORWA; LOCALISATION TO BE

CORE CLAIM

COMPLEMENTARITY → India energy-deficient, Russia energy-surplus

UNIQUE SUPPLY → high-technology equipment including nuclear-powered submarines

MECHANISM

INSTALLED BASE → Su-30MKI licensed production; BrahMos joint venture

2018 → S-400 contract as the named high-end acquisition

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

AK-203 → Indo-Russian Rifles Private Limited at Korwa; localisation to be verified

UNVERIFIED → S-400 delivery status and Russian-crude volumes without an official figure

CORE CLAIM

- COMPLEMENTARITY → India energy-deficient, Russia energy-surplus
- UNIQUE SUPPLY → high-technology equipment including nuclear-powered submarines

MECHANISM

- INSTALLED BASE → Su-30MKI licensed production; BrahMos joint venture
- 2018 → S-400 contract as the named high-end acquisition

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- AK-203 → Indo-Russian Rifles Private Limited at Korwa; localisation to be verified
- UNVERIFIED → S-400 delivery status and Russian-crude volumes without an official figure

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: UNVERIFIED → S-400 delivery status and Russian-crude volumes without an official figure.

05

STAGE 05

INDIA-CHINA PROCESS ARCHITECTURE

INDIA-CHINA PROCESS ARCHITECTURE

21 OCTOBER 2024

PATROLLING ARRANGEMENTS ANNOUNCED; SPECIFIED AS DEPSANG AND DEMCHOK

18 DECEMBER 2024

TWENTY-THIRD SPECIAL REPRESENTATIVES ROUND, BEIJING

19 AUGUST 2025

TWENTY-FOURTH ROUND, NEW DELHI; EXPERT GROUP ON EARLY HARVEST

31 AUGUST 2025

21 OCTOBER 2024 → patrolling arrangements announced; specified as Depsang and Demchok

18 DECEMBER 2024: twenty-third Special Representatives round, Beijing

19 AUGUST 2025: twenty-fourth round, New Delhi

Expert Group on early harvest delimitation

WMCC working group

CORE CLAIM

- 21 OCTOBER 2024 → patrolling arrangements announced; specified as Depsang and Demchok
- 18 DECEMBER 2024: twenty-third Special Representatives round, Beijing
- 19 AUGUST 2025: twenty-fourth round, New Delhi
- Expert Group on early harvest delimitation

MECHANISM

- WMCC working group
- General-Level Mechanisms in Eastern and Middle sectors
- 31 AUGUST 2025: leaders meet at Tianjin
- 27 MAY 2026: thirty-fifth WMCC, Beijing, prepares the next round

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- STATUS → process architecture, expressly not a boundary settlement
- CLOSE DISTINCTION: Border claim, Line of Actual Control perception, agreed boundary,...

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CLOSE DISTINCTION: Border claim, Line of Actual Control perception, agreed boundary,.

06

STAGE 06

DESIGNATED BORDER-TRADE POINTS

DESIGNATED BORDER-TRADE POINTS

EXISTING DESIGNATED POINT PROVIDED FOR IN THE REOPENING ARRANGEMENT

SHIPKI LA

NATHU LA

AGREED AT THE TWENTY-FOURTH SPECIAL REPRESENTATIVES ROUND, 19 AUGUST

PROVISION FOR REOPENING TRADE IS NOT EVIDENCE OF RESUMED

LIPULEKH → existing designated point provided for in the

SHIPKI LA → existing designated point provided for in the

NATHU LA → existing designated point provided for in the

SOURCE → agreed at the twenty-fourth Special Representatives

LIMIT → provision for reopening trade is not evidence of

INDIA, CHINA, MAJOR POWERS AND RESILIENT SUPPLY CHAINS • TILE 2/4 • same master rows 2689-5923 of 11302 • continues below

06

• Expert Group on early harvest delimitation

• 27 MAY 2026: thirty-fifth WMCC, Beijing, prepares the next round

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CLOSE DISTINCTION: Border claim, Line of Actual Control perception, agreed boundary,.

STAGE 06

DESIGNATED BORDER-TRADE POINTS

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EXISTING DESIGNATED POINT PROVIDED FOR IN THE REOPENING ARRANGEMENT

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AGREED AT THE TWENTY-FOURTH SPECIAL REPRESENTATIVES ROUND, 19 AUGUST

PROVISION FOR REOPENING TRADE IS NOT EVIDENCE OF RESUMED

LIPULEKH → existing designated point provided for in the reopening arrangement

SHIPKI LA → existing designated point provided for in the reopening arrangement

NATHU LA → existing designated point provided for in the reopening arrangement

SOURCE → agreed at the twenty-fourth Special Representatives round, 19 August 2025

LIMIT → provision for reopening trade is not evidence of resumed trade volume

CORE CLAIM

LIPULEKH → existing designated point provided for in the reopening arrangement

SHIPKI LA → existing designated point provided for in the reopening arrangement

MECHANISM

NATHU LA → existing designated point provided for in the reopening arrangement

SOURCE → agreed at the twenty-fourth Special Representatives round, 19 August 2025

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

LIMIT → provision for reopening trade is not evidence of resumed trade volume

LIPULEKH → existing designated point provided for in the reopening arrangement

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: LIMIT → provision for reopening trade is not evidence of resumed trade volume.

07

TARIFF CYCLE STRESS TEST

7 AUGUST 2025

25 PER CENT INDIA-SPECIFIC RECIPROCAL DUTY, EXECUTIVE ORDER 14326

27 AUGUST 2025

ADDITIONAL 25 PER CENT RUSSIAN-OIL-LINKED DUTY, EXECUTIVE ORDER 14329

4 AND 6 AUGUST 2025

INDIA CALLS THE ACTION UNJUSTIFIED AND UNREASONABLE

7 FEBRUARY 2026

7 AUGUST 2025 → 25 per cent India-specific reciprocal duty, Executive Order 14326

27 AUGUST 2025 → additional 25 per cent Russian-oil-linked duty, Executive Order 14329

4 AND 6 AUGUST 2025 → India calls the action unjustified and unreasonable

7 FEBRUARY 2026 → additional duty removed, Executive Order 14384

FEBRUARY 2026 → IEEPA additional duties ended by Executive Order 14389

CORE CLAIM

7 AUGUST 2025 → 25 per cent India-specific reciprocal duty, Executive Order 14326

27 AUGUST 2025 → additional 25 per cent Russian-oil-linked duty, Executive Order 14329

4 AND 6 AUGUST 2025 → India calls the action unjustified and unreasonable

MECHANISM

7 FEBRUARY 2026 → additional duty removed, Executive Order 14384

FEBRUARY 2026 → IEEPA additional duties ended by Executive Order 14389

24 JULY 2026 → separate 10 per cent Section 301 duty on specified Indian goods

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

READING → partnership and coercive trade measures ran from the same partner at once

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: READING → partnership and coercive trade measures ran from the same partner at once.

08

JAPAN DIVERSIFICATION PILLAR

ELEVATED TO A SPECIAL STRATEGIC AND GLOBAL PARTNERSHIP

20 AUGUST 2024

THIRD TWO-PLUS-TWO AGREES TO REVISE THE 2008 SECURITY DECLARATION

SEPTEMBER 2020

RECIPROCAL PROVISION OF SUPPLIES AND SERVICES SIGNED; OPERATIONAL 2021

SINCE 2017

JICA COMMITMENTS EXCEEDING ONE TRILLION YEN FOR HIGH-SPEED RAIL

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
2014 → elevated to a Special Strategic and Global Partnership	SEPTEMBER 2020 → Reciprocal Provision of Supplies and Services signed; operational 2021	APRIL 2021 → Supply Chain Resilience Initiative with Australia and Japan
20 AUGUST 2024 → third two-plus-two agrees to revise the 2008 security declaration	SINCE 2017 → JICA commitments exceeding one trillion yen for high-speed rail	LIMIT → logistics access is not collective defence; matching is not relocated production

CORE CLAIM

2014 → elevated to a Special Strategic and Global Partnership

20 AUGUST 2024 → third two-plus-two agrees to revise the 2008 security declaration

MECHANISM

SEPTEMBER 2020 → Reciprocal Provision of Supplies and Services signed; operational 2021

SINCE 2017 → JICA commitments exceeding one trillion yen for high-speed rail

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

APRIL 2021 → Supply Chain Resilience Initiative with Australia and Japan

LIMIT → logistics access is not collective defence; matching is not relocated production

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: LIMIT → logistics access is not collective defence; matching is not relocated production.

09

EUROPEAN UNION PILLAR AND LEGAL STATUS

TRADE AND TECHNOLOGY COUNCIL FOR TECHNOLOGY, GREEN TRANSITION AND

27 JANUARY 2026

FREE TRADE AGREEMENT NEGOTIATIONS CONCLUDED

LEGAL REVIEW AND RATIFICATION REMAINED NECESSARY BEFORE ENTRY INTO

A CONCLUDED NEGOTIATION IS NEITHER SIGNATURE NOR ENTRY INTO

WIDER TECHNOLOGY, MARKET AND REGULATORY OPTIONS BEYOND US-CHINA COMPETITION

CHANNEL → Trade and Technology Council for technology, green transition and standards

27 JANUARY 2026 → free trade agreement negotiations concluded

PENDING → legal review and ratification remained necessary before entry into force

CONSEQUENCE → a concluded negotiation is neither signature nor entry into force

GAIN → wider technology, market and regulatory options beyond US-China competition

CORE CLAIM

CHANNEL → Trade and Technology Council for technology, green transition and standards

MECHANISM

PENDING → legal review and ratification remained necessary before entry into force

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

GAIN → wider technology, market and regulatory options beyond US-China competition

INDIA, CHINA, MAJOR POWERS AND RESILIENT SUPPLY CHAINS • TILE 3/4 • same master rows 5379-8613 of 11302 • continues below

09

STAGE 09 EUROPEAN UNION PILLAR AND LEGAL STATUS

EUROPEAN UNION PILLAR AND LEGAL STATUS

TRADE AND TECHNOLOGY COUNCIL FOR TECHNOLOGY, GREEN TRANSITION AND

27 JANUARY 2026

FREE TRADE AGREEMENT NEGOTIATIONS CONCLUDED

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GAIN → wider technology, market and regulatory options beyond US-China competition

CORE CLAIM

- CHANNEL → Trade and Technology Council for technology, green transition and standards
- 27 JANUARY 2026 → free trade agreement negotiations concluded

MECHANISM

- PENDING → legal review and ratification remained necessary before entry into force
- CONSEQUENCE → a concluded negotiation is neither signature nor entry into force

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- GAIN → wider technology, market and regulatory options beyond US-China competition
- CHANNEL → Trade and Technology Council for technology, green transition and standards

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: GAIN → wider technology, market and regulatory options beyond US-China competition.

10

STAGE 10 UKRAINE ENGINE AND MINILATERAL BALANCING

UKRAINE ENGINE AND MINILATERAL BALANCING

DIALOGUE AND DIPLOMACY; SOVEREIGNTY AND TERRITORIAL INTEGRITY INVOKED

UN POSTURE

GENERALLY ABSTAINED ON POLARISING RESOLUTIONS; HUMANITARIAN ASSISTANCE SENT

ENERGY AND FERTILISER

DISCOUNTED SUPPLIES REDIRECTED TOWARD INDIA

SANCTIONS RISK, PAYMENT AND LOGISTICS FRICTION, UNILATERAL TARIFF PRESSURE

NON-TREATY QUAD AND I2U2 ADD CHANNELS AT A COORDINATION

PRINCIPLES → dialogue and diplomacy; sovereignty and territorial integrity invoked

UN POSTURE: generally abstained on polarising resolutions; humanitarian assistance sent

ENERGY AND FERTILISER: discounted supplies redirected toward India

EXPOSURE: sanctions risk, payment and logistics friction, unilateral tariff pressure

MINILATERAL: non-treaty Quad and I2U2 add channels at a coordination cost

CORE CLAIM

- PRINCIPLES → dialogue and diplomacy; sovereignty and territorial integrity invoked
- UN POSTURE: generally abstained on polarising resolutions; humanitarian assistance sent

MECHANISM

- ENERGY AND FERTILISER: discounted supplies redirected toward India
- EXPOSURE: sanctions risk, payment and logistics friction, unilateral tariff pressure

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- MINILATERAL: non-treaty Quad and I2U2 add channels at a coordination cost
- SPILLOVER → Black Sea disruption affected food, fertiliser, freight and energy markets

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: SPILLOVER → Black Sea disruption affected food, fertiliser, freight and energy markets.

11

STAGE 11 ANSWER SPINE FOR A MAJOR-POWER DEMAND

ANSWER SPINE FOR A MAJOR-POWER DEMAND

STATE THE STRUCTURAL DIFFERENCE BETWEEN THE CHINA, UNITED STATES

EVIDENCE EACH TRACK WITH ONE DATED INSTRUMENT AT ITS

PRICE THE TARIFF CYCLE AND THE TECHNOLOGY-ACCESS FRICTION AS

REFUSE THE REPLACEMENT NARRATIVE AND RELINK THE VERDICT TO

EVIDENCE LIMIT

DISTINGUISH ANNOUNCED INITIATIVE

OPEN → state the structural difference between the China, United States and Russia ties

BUILD → evidence each track with one dated instrument at its exact evidentiary level

TEST → price the tariff cycle and the technology-access friction as real, dated limits

CLOSE → refuse the replacement narrative and relink the verdict to strategic autonomy

EVIDENCE LIMIT: STATUS / LEVELS / IMPLEMENTATION: Distinguish announced initiative

CORE CLAIM

- OPEN → state the structural difference between the China, United States and Russia ties
- BUILD → evidence each track with one dated instrument at its exact evidentiary level

MECHANISM

- TEST → price the tariff cycle and the technology-access friction as real, dated limits
- CLOSE → refuse the replacement narrative and relink the verdict to strategic autonomy

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- EVIDENCE LIMIT: STATUS / LEVELS / IMPLEMENTATION: Distinguish announced initiative,...
- OPEN → state the structural difference between the China, United States and Russia ties

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CLOSE → refuse the replacement narrative and relink the verdict to strategic autonomy.

E

EXTRA SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT

ICET (ANNOUNCED MAY 2022; INAUGURAL NSA-LEVEL MEETING 31 JANUARY

INDIA-US CLEAN-ENERGY SUPPLY-CHAIN COMMITMENTS (21 SEPTEMBER 2024)

TRUST AND COMPACT (13 FEBRUARY 2025)

THE CURRENT INDIA-US TECHNOLOGY

FRAMEWORK FOR THE US-INDIA MAJOR DEFENSE PARTNERSHIP (KUALA LUMPUR

THE 2025-26 US TARIFF CYCLE AS AN ARCHITECTURE STRESS

A 25%

OPTIONAL SOURCE DEPTH

- iCET (announced May 2022; inaugural NSA-level meeting 31 January 2023;
- India-US clean-energy supply-chain commitments (21 September 2024);
- TRUST and COMPACT (13 February 2025): the current India-US technology
- Framework for the US-India Major Defense Partnership (Kuala Lumpur, 31

ADVANCED DEBATE

- The 2025-26 US tariff cycle as an architecture stress test: a 25%
- India-Russia continuity architecture: the 23rd Annual Summit (New
- India-China border and dialogue architecture: the patrolling
- CAUTION: Quad and I2U2 as minilateral supply-chain vehicles: these

LEGACY / NUANCE

- Direct PYQ boundary case (2024 Q9): the supplied paper text reads
- CAUTION: Boundary case — trade deficit with China as economic grievance layered
- CAUTION: Boundary case — Russia-US simultaneous engagement: the continued
- CAUTION: Boundary case — unresolved technology-access asymmetry with the US:

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.